monsoon period in recent years. This regular event briefly attracted international press attention in May 2015. Perhaps the most disturbing aspect of the refugee crisis from the point of view of ordinary observers was that in early summer 2015, when the crisis finally came fully to our attention, there was no obvious immediate trigger in the internal situation in Myanmar.[76] The 2015 refugee crisis was not a direct outcome of a particular policy decision, or even of a new outburst of violence. It is quite simply what happens when human beings are expected to live in intolerable conditions.

Many Rohingyas seem to have themselves accepted that there is no place for them in Myanmar. To give just one example as to why they have done so, the level of persecution and exclusion has been normalised to the point where hospitals in Rahkine refuse to treat Rohingya people, especially if they have been beaten up by the police or army.[77] Steven Kiersons of the Sentinel Project for Genocide Prevention summarises: 'There is an utter loss of hope for the future, and people are risking their lives whether they stay in Burma or go abroad'.[78] What is more, not all the Rohingyas who leave do so voluntarily:

> There was a group of six men, they were Rakhine Buddhists from Bangladesh, they had knives and guns. They forced me to get on a boat, they told me I was leaving Myanmar [Burma]. They pushed me to the small boat, I fell into the water up to my shoulders. Fifteen other Rohingya were on that boat. All the people were forced onto the boat.[79]

There are other reports that among those paying to flee are many who are forced onto the refugee boats as part of the political goal of removing the Rohingyas. This makes former Australian prime minister Tony Abbott calling the boat people 'reckless' all the more unedifying. When asked if Australia would consider resettling any Rohingyas found to be refugees, he replied 'Nope, nope, nope'.[80] Fortunately, not all world leaders have been so indifferent. Pope Francis has described the persecution of the Rohingyas as a 'form of war':

> Let's think of those brothers of ours of the Rohingya, they were chased from one country and from another and from another, when they arrived at a port or a beach, they gave them a bit of water or a bit to eat and were there chased out to the sea. This is a conflict that has not resolved, and this is war, this is called violence, this is called killing![81]

The fate of the refugees